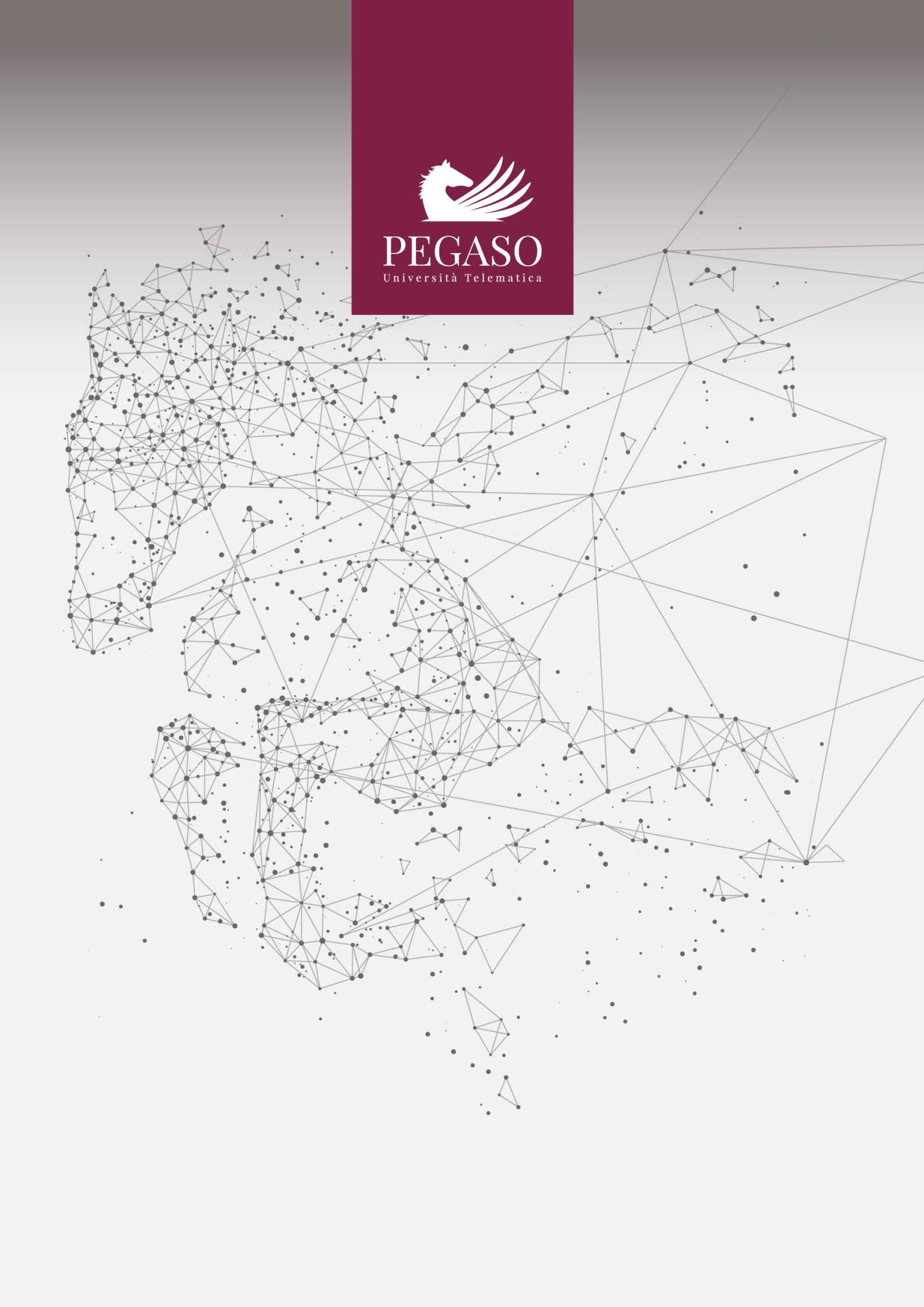

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Indice

1. PRONOUNS....3
2. NOUNS....6
3. QUANTIFIERS....9
BIBLIOGRAFIA....14

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

1. Pronouns

Pronouns substitute or replace nouns or noun phrases when the named noun or noun phrase is already known in the context.

There are different kinds of pronouns in the English language.

Subject and Object Pronouns

SUBJECT		OBJECT	
I	I know Tom.	**me**	Tom knows me.
we	We know Tom.	**us**	Tom knows us.
You	You know Tom.	**you**	Tom knows you.
he	He knows Tom.	**him**	Tom knows him.
she	She knows Tom.	**her**	Tom knows her.
it	It is cold.	**it**	I am not happy with it.
they	They know Tom.	**them**	Tom knows them.

These pronouns replace the active agent of an action (subject) or the inactive recipient of an action (object).

Possessive Pronouns

For possession in English we can use different structures:

Possessive adjectives are used together with a noun to establish the ownership / belonging.

Ex. That is my new phone. Please don't drop it.

We can also use the possessive **'s** together with a noun to indicate ownership / belonging.

Ex. Diane is Margaret's sister.

My sister's dog is so cute.

Susan's sister's husband is named Jim. (Jim is the husband of Susan's sister.)

Possessive pronouns also indicate who something belongs to. However, they replace the noun so we use them alone. In this case, we don't use **its**.

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

In English, the possessive pronouns are: **mine, yours, his, hers, ours** and **theirs**.

I have a bag - this is mine.

You have a cat - that cat is yours.

He has a car - it is his.

She has a book - it is hers.

We have a flat - it is ours.

They have a daughter - she is theirs.

A: Whose car is parked outside? B: It's mine.

A: Alice and Steve have moved into a different home. Did they buy it together?

B: No, it's been her since her old aunt died. She inherited it.

Reflexive Pronouns

Reflexive pronouns (myself, yourself, him/her/itself, ourselves, yourselves, themselves) are used:

When the subject and object of a transitive verb are the same:

He stopped himself from saying something.

I hurt myself when I fell over.

to mean 'without the help of others'.

I cleaned the car myself.

We booked the holiday ourselves.

With **by** to mean **alone / on your own**:

Are you going to town by yourself?

With **enjoy, behave,** etc. when there is no object:

Enjoy yourself!

Behave yourselves!

To add emphasis to the subject or object:

The President himself spoke to me.

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

The actors were good but the film itself was boring.[1]

Relative Pronouns

The most common relative pronouns are:
who (= subject) and whom (= object) to refer to people
which to refer to things
that to refer to either people or things
whose the possessive of who and which
when used after nouns referring to time
where used after nouns referring to place
why used to refer to reasons

Note: the relative pronoun replaces the subject or the object.

Chris is the son of a woman who works in television.
That's the man whose son is an actor.
Winter was the time when people tended to get insufficient fresh food.
The museum, where you can see Roman pottery, is free.
The witness, who refused to be named, said the police had acted unwisely.

[1] J. Bell and A. Thomas, *Gold First Coursebook New Edition*, Essex, Pearson Education Limited, 2014 (173)

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

2. Nouns

Some nouns are countable. This means they can become plural, for example computer, bag, box, magazine etc. This also means that in the singular we can use *a / an* to indicate one.

Other nouns are uncountable. This means they cannot normally become plural, for example rubbish, plastic, paper, metal. This also means that they cannot be singular and therefore we cannot use *a / an* to indicate one (these nouns cannot be counted – not even just one time).

Uncountable nouns

The following nouns are always uncountable: accommodation, behaviour, health, politics (and other words ending in -ics, e.g. athletics, economics), progress, rubbish, scenery, traffic, weather, work.

Uncountable nouns don't have a plural form, and they use a singular verb. (The sceneries are beautiful here.)

Don't use **a / an** with uncountable nouns. (There's a terrible traffic this evening.)

These nouns are also uncountable: advice, bread, equipment, furniture, homework, information, luck, luggage, news, research, toast.

With these, you can use a **piece of to** talk about an individual item.

Either Countable (C) or Uncountable (U), but with a Change in Meaning

e.g. a glass (C) = the thing you

drink out of; glass (U) = the material used to make windows

Other examples: business, iron, light, paper, space, time, chocolate, coffee, cake

Plural and Collective Nouns

1. arms (= guns, etc.), belongings, clothes, manners, outskirts, scissors, and trousers / shorts are plural nouns with no singular. They need a plural verb, and they can't be used with a / an.

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

If the word refers to something with two parts, e.g. scissors, shorts, trousers, etc., it can be used with **a pair of** or **some**.

2. crew, family, government, police, staff, team, etc. are collective nouns and refer to a group of people. We use them with a singular verb when we are referring to the group,

Example:

My family is very big. (with a singular verb when we are thinking of the family as a unit)

OR

My family are all very talkative. (with a plural verb when we are thinking of the people as individuals)

Take note: the word **police** is always used with a plural verb.[2]

Compound Nouns

Compound nouns are created by putting two nouns together. These new nouns are in one of two forms. There is no rule for when you join the words or maintain them as separate words, so check a dictionary when in doubt.

two nouns joined together:

motor + bike = motorbike.

two nouns together but as separate words:

car + parking = car parking.

Exercises

Complete the compound nouns in the sentences with these words.

centre

credit

driver

seat

time

town

transport

[2] C. Latham-Koening, C. Oxenden, K. Chomacki, *English File Upper-Intermediate Fourth Edition*, Oxford, Oxford University Press, 2020 (149)

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

snow

1. Sorry, we don't accept _____cards, only cash

2. He works at night so he often sleeps in the day _____.

3. There are road works in the town _____so you shouldn‘t drive to the cinema this evening.

4. I know I should take public _____but it's easier to drive my own car.

5. A _____mobile looks like a lot of fun to drive.

6. Do you have any change to pay the taxi_____?

7. The _____council is meeting tonight to discuss the problem of car parking.

8. I always book a window _____when I travel by plane.[3]

[3] J. Hughes, *Life Pre-Intermediate Workbook Second Edition*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (27)

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

3. Quantifiers

We use quantifiers with nouns to talk about quantity.

The choice of quantifier depends on:

-if the noun is countable or uncountable.

-if we are talking about small or large quantities.

For a neutral quantity (not large or small) in an affirmative sentence:

Some – for both countable and uncountable nouns (note that a countable noun must be in the plural form)

I found some really useful books in the library. (= not a lot)

I have some time to help you.

She had some questions for the manager.

For a small quantity:

With countable nouns (note that a countable noun must be in the plural form):

a few

We have a few eggs left in the fridge.

I have a few really good friends.

not + many (in a negative sentence)

I don’t have many friends.

With uncountable nouns:

a little

There is a little sugar in your coffee.

There's a little milk in the bottle.

not + much (in a negative sentence)

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d’autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Note: although **many** and **much** mean a "large" quantity, we don't normally use them in affirmative sentences in spoken English. We tend to use **a lot of** or **lots of** instead to indicate a large quantity. We use **many + plural noun** to talk about large quantities only in more formal English.

There are many interesting places to visit in the city.

We also use many and much in questions.

Are there many good shops where you live?

Do you have much free time?

For no quantity (zero):

not + any (in a negative sentence) - with both countable and uncountable nouns

to talk about zero quantity (when there is nothing)

We didn't have any information on the new product line.

I don't have any money.

There weren't any shops open when we arrived.

To ask questions:

any in the interrogative form

Are there any good beaches in the area?

Do you have any orange juice?[4]

More exercises

Choose the correct quantifier. In one sentence both quantifiers are correct.

9. How *much / many* rubbish do you recycle?
10. I recycle a *few / a little* things, like glass and plastic bottles.
11. I don't recycle *many / much* glass.
12. I recycle *a few / a little* paper each week.
13. Do you have *much / any* recycling bins?
14. There are *some / any* old TVs for sale at the market.
15. A lot of people on my street don't recycle *many / much* plastic.
16. You shouldn't throw away *many / any* paper! Always recycle it.
17. Nowadays, *a lot of / some* cities and towns have special places to take recycling.[5]

[4] . Hughes, H. Stephenson and P. Dummett, *Life Pre-Intermediate Student's Book*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (164)
[5] J. Hughes, H. Stephenson and P. Dummett, *Life Pre-Intermediate Student's Book*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (59)

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Circle the correct form. Tick (V) if both are correct.

18. The traffic *is / are* awful during the rush hour.

19. Athletics *is / are* my favourite sport.

20. I bought *a pair of / some* new jeans.

21. Harvey's clothes *look / looks* really expensive.

22. The flight crew *work / works* hard to make passengers comfortable.

23. I found out *some / a piece* of interesting information at the meeting.

Right (**R**) or wrong (**W**)?

Correct the mistakes in the following phrases.

24. Our accommodation isn't satisfactory. Ex. **R**

25. The news are good. Ex. **W** The news is…

26. We had a beautiful weather when we were on holiday.

27. They have some lovely furnitures in their house.

28. My brother gave me a useful piece of advice.

29. Do you have a scissors? I need to wrap this present.

30. The hotel staff are real professionals.

31. I need to buy a new trousers for my interview tomorrow.

32.Your glasses are really dirty. Can you see anything?

33. The homeworks were very difficult last night.

34. There isn't any more space in my suitcase. Can I put this jacket in yours?

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

35. The police is sure that they know who was responsible for the vandalism.[6]

Exercise answer key

1. credit card
2. daytime
3. town centre
4. public transport
5. snowmobile
6. taxi driver
7. town council
8. window seat
9. much
10. a few
11. much
12. a little
13. any
14. some
15. much
16. any
17. a lot of
18. is
19. is
20. a pair of
21. looks
22. works
23. some
24. **R**
25. **W** The news is good…
26. **W** We had beautiful weather…
27. **W** They have some lovely furniture…
28. **R**
29. **W** Do you have some scissors?

[6] C. Latham-Koening, C. Oxenden, K. Chomacki, *English File Upper-Intermediate Fourth Edition*, Oxford, Oxford University Press, 2020 (149)

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

30. **R**
31. **W** I need to buy a new pair of trousers…/ I need to buy some new trousers…
32. **R**
33. **W** The homework was…
34. **R**
35. **W** The police are sure…

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Bibliografia

- J. Bell and A. Thomas, Gold First Coursebook New Edition, Essex, Pearson Education Limited, 2014
- C. Latham-Koening, C. Oxenden, K. Chomacki, English File Upper-Intermediate Fourth Edition, Oxford, Oxford University Press, 2020
- J. Hughes, H. Stephenson and P. Dummett, Life Pre-Intermediate Student's Book, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019
- J. Hughes, Life Pre-Intermediate Workbook Second Edition, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).